Md Asif Iqbal

Barrister-at-Law, Lincoln's Inn

Advocate, Supreme Court of Bangladesh • High Court Division

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Bangladesh-qualified advocate and English-trained barrister with experience in corporate transactions, banking and finance, competition law, litigation and arbitration. His work includes legal due diligence, transaction and security documents, regulatory submissions and hearing preparation, working with senior advocates and international counsel.

Professional qualifications

20 May 2026	**Advocate, Supreme Court of Bangladesh** High Court Division
2021	**Advocate, Bangladesh Bar Council** Enrolled to practise in the subordinate courts
2018	**Barrister-at-Law, Lincoln's Inn** Called to the Bar of England and Wales

Current and previous affiliations

Nov 2022–present	**Dr. Kamal Hossain & Associates** Associate, Dhaka
Jan–Oct 2022	**Dr. Kamal Hossain & Associates** Intern, Dhaka
Mar–Aug 2021	**Novartis (Bangladesh) Limited** Apprentice–Legal
Jan 2018–Mar 2019	**Supreme Law Chambers** Associate

Secondments through DKHA: Standard Chartered Bank — property (2023–2024); finance and banking products (2024–2026).

Education

2017	**University of Law, London** Bar Professional Training Course — Competent; Postgraduate Diploma in Professional Legal Skills — 62%
2014	**University of East London** LL.B. (Honours) — Upper Second Class (2:1), 62%
2010	**University of London International Programmes** Diploma in Law — 2:2, 52%

Selected corporate transactions

1. Coca-Cola İçecek acquisition

US$130 million • 100% stake • 2023–2024

Worked in the Bangladesh co-counsel team on the acquisition of Coca-Cola Bangladesh Beverages Limited. Prepared the Bangladesh due diligence report, drafted local transaction documents and assisted with share-transfer registration and Competition Commission representations.

2. Professional services acquisition

Cross-border acquisition • 2026–present

Prepared Bangladesh legal due diligence and transaction-document inputs for a proposed acquisition in the professional services sector, covering corporate ownership, security interests and financing restrictions.

3. Professional services share transfer

Transaction documentation • 2026–present

Reviewed and revised transaction documents for a proposed share transfer in the professional services sector, addressing transfer mechanics, contractual safeguards, enforceability and regulatory requirements.

4. Social enterprise restructuring

Three social enterprises • 2025–2026

Prepared due diligence and advice for a major NGO on a proposed court-sanctioned scheme of arrangement, asset and liability transfers and valuation. Worked on employee transfers, continuity of service, accrued rights, novation and statutory funds.

5. Softlogic Life Insurance PLC

Proposed US$1.9 million acquisition • 60% stake • 2025–2026

Worked in the Bangladesh counsel team on the proposed acquisition of a controlling stake in Diamond Life Insurance Company Limited and related Bangladesh market-entry issues.

6. LEO Group Co., Ltd.

Proposed HKEX Main Board listing • 2026

Conducted due diligence on the Bangladesh subsidiary and prepared Bangladesh legal opinion and due diligence materials for the proposed Hong Kong listing.

7. Online grocery investment

Investment due diligence • 2026–present

Prepared legal due diligence for a proposed investment in an online grocery business, covering financing, security interests, material contracts, intellectual property and regulatory compliance.

8. Ready-made garments group acquisition

Cross-border transaction • 2022–2023

Worked with Latham & Watkins on red-flag Bangladesh legal due diligence for an upstream acquisition of a ready-made garments group.

9. Bank and mobile financial services acquisition

Initial regulatory assessment • 2026

Prepared an initial report on commercial and digital banking licences, MFS eligibility, foreign ownership, control and shareholding limits, board requirements, approvals, listed-bank takeover rules and foreign exchange. Assessed acquisition and new-bank establishment options.

Banking finance and advisory

Banking and finance

1. Standard Chartered Bank — Akij financing

Master Murabaha • BDT448.05 crore mortgage value • 2024–2025

Worked on the Akij Food and Beverage ECA-backed Islamic financing. Conducted land and corporate due diligence, prepared the due diligence report and security documents, and reviewed conditions precedent.

2. SML Holdings Limited

Multi-jurisdictional financing • 2025–2026

Worked with Goodwin Procter on cross-border financing. Prepared due diligence reports and transaction documents and advised on Bangladesh law issues.

3. Eastern Bank PLC — Banglalink syndicated loan

Lead-arranger mandate • 2023

Worked on the lead arranger's mandate for a syndicated term loan to Banglalink Digital Communications Limited. Reviewed the facility agreement and drafted the subordination deed.

4. Standard Chartered Bank secondments

Property: 2023–2024 • Finance and banking products: 2024–2026

Supported land and property due diligence, project finance, Diminishing Musharaka, Master Murabaha and ECA-backed facilities. Worked on treasury bonds, bancassurance and escrow arrangements.

5. Syndicated lending security

Negative lien documentation • 2026

Assisted with reviewing negative lien documentation for a syndicated term loan involving leasehold project land and restrictions on further encumbrances.

Regulatory and commercial advisory

6. Khan Academy Bangladesh operations

Digital education and regulatory compliance • 2023–2026

Advised on structuring Bangladesh operations and reviewed operating and trademark licence agreements, data-protection terms and school-facing documents. Addressed children's data and consent, remittances, tax and dispute-resolution provisions.

7. Core banking implementation

Technology procurement and contract remedies • 2026

Assisted with preparing an opinion for a commercial bank on a core banking system upgrade, including vendor obligations, cure provisions, fresh procurement and contractual remedies.

8. Grameen University

Governance and constitutional documents • 2025–2026

Prepared amendments to the Trust Deed and Memorandum of Association and coordinated execution, registration and RJSC filing steps. Reviewed an employee-outsourcing agreement and related contractual and employment issues.

9. Jamuna University

Establishment and governance • 2025

Drafted and revised the trust deed, memorandum and rules for the proposed university. Advised on governance, trustees' remuneration and the use of university funds.

10. Index Companies

Power purchase tariff regulation • From 2026

Advised on regulatory issues concerning conversion of PPA tariff payments from BDT to USD and prepared representations to the Bangladesh Power Development Board.

Competition constitutional and commercial disputes

Competition proceedings

1. JT International Bangladesh Limited

Competition Case No. 04/2021 • Work in 2023–2024

Worked in the team on proceedings involving British American Tobacco Bangladesh and alleged abuse of dominance and restrictive retail practices. Prepared objections, replies and review materials addressing investigation reports and supported hearing preparation and client reporting.

2. BRAC Seed & Agro Enterprise

Competition Case No. 28/2022 • Work in 2023–2025

Prepared objections and submissions on rice pricing, market share, licensing, cost of goods sold and pricing evidence. Appeared before the Competition Commission and supported preparation through the final-hearing stage.

3. Ship handling and stevedoring at Chattogram Port

Competition Case No. 58/2022 • Work in 2022–2023

Assisted Kazi Ataul-Al-Osman in proceedings involving the Bangladesh Ship Handling and Berth Operators Association. Drafted applications to reject the complaint and modify an order, addressing monopoly allegations, licensing responsibility and cause of action.

4. Coca-Cola Bangladesh acquisition representations

Post-acquisition regulatory engagement • March 2024

Attended the Competition Commission's meeting on 10 March 2024 with Dr. Sharif Bhuiyan and client representatives. Assisted with written representations on prior approval and follow-up transaction, valuation and financial materials.

Constitutional litigation and dispute resolution

5. Constitutional amendment proceedings

Fifteenth and Thirteenth Amendments • 2024–2026

Assisted Dr. Sharif Bhuiyan in Writ Petition No. 9935 of 2024 and subsequent appeals, Civil Review Petition No. 200 of 2024 and Civil Appeal No. 112 of 2025. Conducted research, drafted applications and prepared hearing materials.

6. Judicial independence and Article 116

Writ Petition No. 10356 of 2024

Assisted Dr. Sharif Bhuiyan in his role as court-appointed amicus curiae, undertaking research and preparing materials concerning Article 116 and judicial independence.

7. Ascott International Management Pte. Ltd.

Trademark enforcement • With Bird & Bird • 2025–2026

Assisted with pleadings, non-use cancellation applications, a contempt notice and hearing preparation in trademark appeal, opposition and civil suit proceedings. Coordinated with international counsel on procedural updates.

8. ICC commercial arbitration

Industrial equipment services dispute • 2026

Assisted in preparing and filing a Request for Arbitration for a Bangladesh industrial company. Researched contractual issues and assisted with subsequent procedural submissions and client communications.

Further experience and professional activities

1. Singer Bangladesh labour proceedings

Wage cases and appeals • 2023–2026

Prepared and revised written submissions and conducted hearings in labour wage cases and appeals.

2. Isuzu Motors commercial litigation

Money Suit No. 10 of 2024 • Work in 2025–2026

Worked with Nagashima Ohno & Tsunematsu and appeared before the Joint District Judge, 3rd Court, Dhaka, in proceedings concerning an application to strike out Isuzu as a defendant.

3. Hospital shareholder dispute

Company law, mediation and arbitration • 2022

Advised a hospital and its board on company-law issues and represented it in mediation and arbitration concerning a majority–minority shareholder dispute.

4. Anti-Corruption Commission proceedings

Trial and related High Court proceedings • 2025–2026

Worked on defence proceedings, discharge and personal-attendance exemption applications, and a related application under section 561A of the Code of Criminal Procedure. Prepared supplementary affidavit materials and coordinated with the bank's legal team.

5. Guardianship and child custody proceedings

Family Court and Appellate Division • 2025–2026

Assisted Sara Hossain, Senior Advocate, with hearing preparation, supporting documents, additional paper-book applications, settlement and guardianship-certificate issues.

6. Court-record verification for UK proceedings

Bangladesh court enquiries and reporting • 2026

Conducted court-record enquiries in Sylhet and assisted with a verification report for use in UK immigration appeal proceedings, documenting case status, orders and the verification methodology.

7. Commercial property

Multinational food and beverage group • 2025

Reviewed property due diligence and lease documentation, revised the Bangladesh office lease deed and advised on registration requirements.

Writing and editorial work

Article. A citizen's solution to Dhaka's traffic problem. The Daily Star, March 2022.

Editorial assistance. Revolutionary Constitutionalism and Why it was Essential to Declare the Fifteenth Amendment Unconstitutional. Dr. Sharif Bhuiyan, 2025. Assisted Dr. Sharif Bhuiyan with editing the book.

Legal technology

Founder of Lexintell (2021), a Bangladesh legal database. Winner of the Bangladesh round of the Global Legal Hackathon (2022); portfolio startup under the ICT Division's iDEA Project (2022).

Memberships and languages

Lincoln's Inn (since 2017); Dhaka Bar Association and Dhaka Tax Bar Association (since 2021).

Bangla (native); English (fluent).